

The landlord told me his house was full, and I agreed, rather than wander further on so bitter a night, to share a harpooneer's blanket if he were not decidedly objectionable.

My misgivings grew; I changed my mind about that harpooneer and tried the bench for a bed, till the knots, planes, and freezing draughts beat me off the plan.



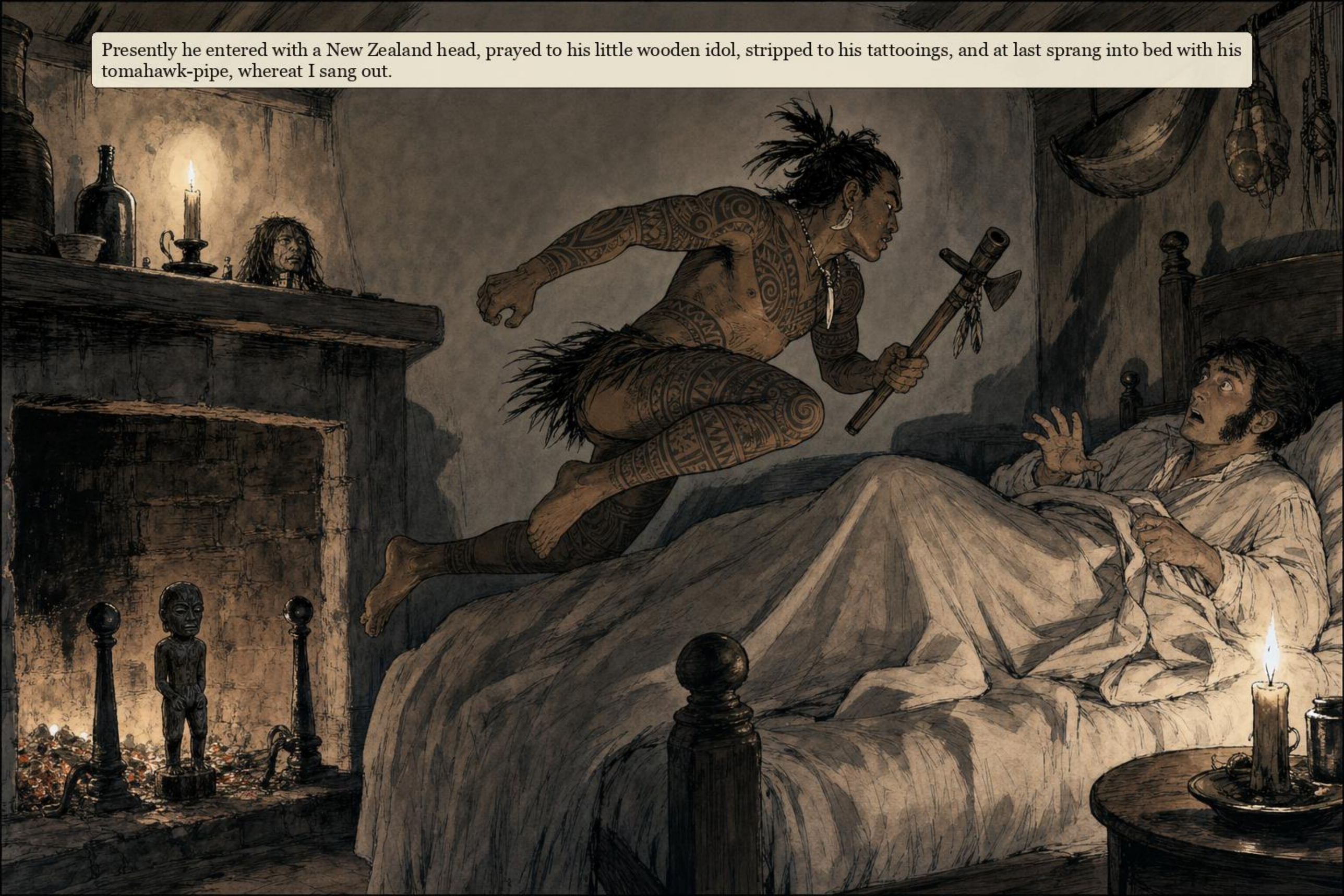


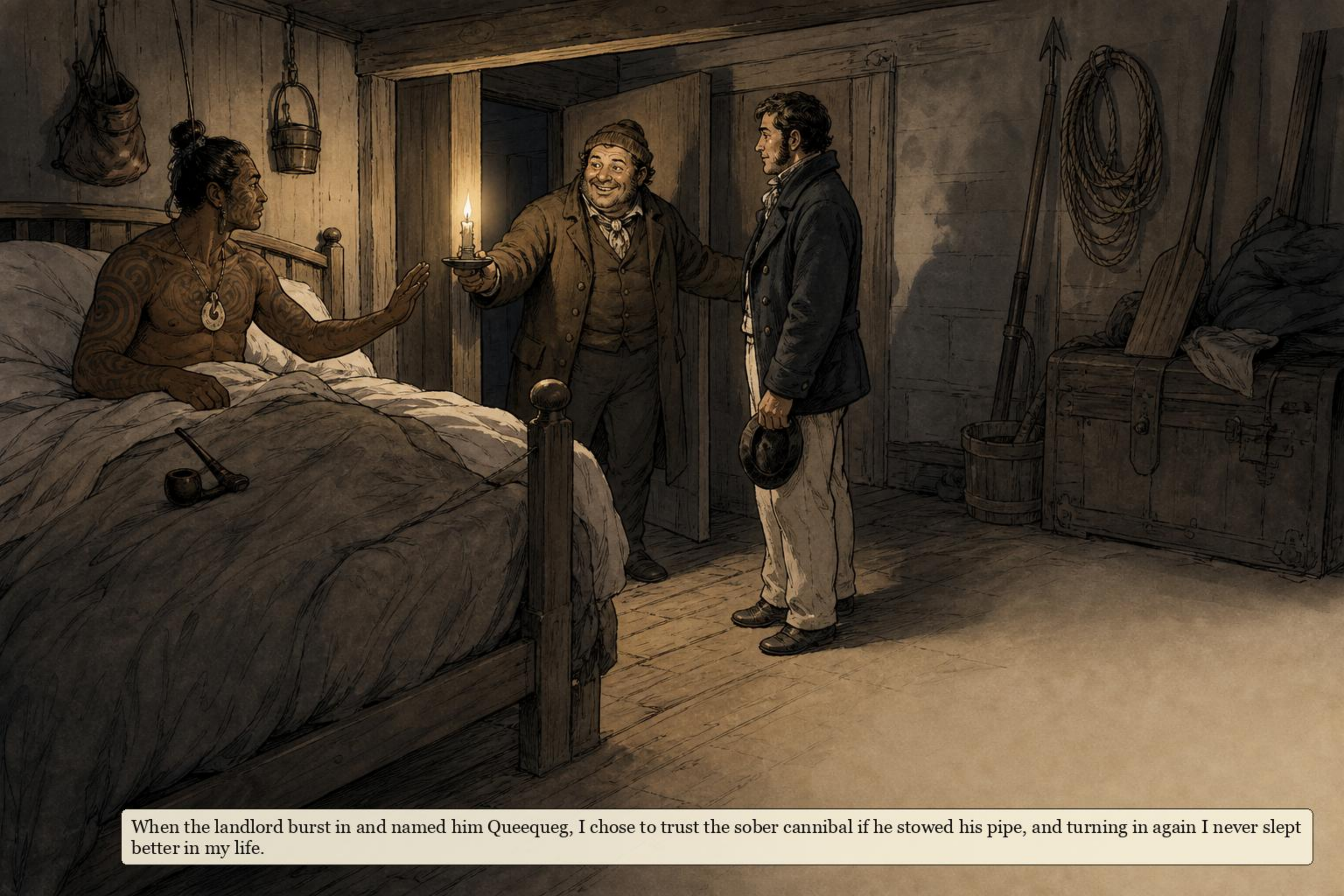
Close upon midnight I made the landlord speak out, learned the talk of 'selling his head' meant 'balmed New Zealand heads, and yet let him lead me up to the prodigious bed.

Alone, I examined the harpooneer's outlandish gear, even tried on his shaggy door-mat poncho, then, thinking he would not come, blew out the light and turned in.



Presently he entered with a New Zealand head, prayed to his little wooden idol, stripped to his tattooings, and at last sprang into bed with his tomahawk-pipe, whereat I sang out.





When the landlord burst in and named him Queequeg, I chose to trust the sober cannibal if he stowed his pipe, and turning in again I never slept better in my life.